

Netanyahu dismisses attorney general

Leader under increasing domestic, U.S. pressure to resolve war in Gaza

BY SHIRA RUBIN AND LIOR SOROKA

TEL AVIV — Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's far-right government voted unanimously Monday to dismiss his attorney general, Gali Baharav-Miara, the chief prosecutor in his ongoing corruption case, as he faces growing criticism inside Israel and U.S. impatience over his government's management of the war in Gaza.

The vote to remove Baharav-Miara, a frequent critic of the government's policies, marks one of the more significant steps in Netanyahu's years-long effort to exert political influence over the country's legal system. It is also expected to lead to a confrontation between the elected government and the appointed justices on Israel's Supreme Court, who will review and rule on the legality of Baharav-Miara's removal.

Immediately after the vote, opposition party Yesh Atid filed a petition to block the move, as did the Movement for Quality Government in Israel, a watchdog group that said the vote would politicize the office of the attorney general. In response, Supreme Court Deputy President Noam Sohlberg issued a temporary order freezing the decision.

In a letter to her staff, Baharav-Miara wrote that the government's decision was unlawful. "Political pressure will not deter

SEE ISRAEL ON A12

Israeli plans: Netanyahu wants military to occupy all of Gaza. **A12**

In gene, clues to humans' success over Neanderthals

BY CAROLYN Y. JOHNSON

Scientists have a new clue in the long quest to decipher what makes us uniquely human: tiny changes in brain chemistry that set us apart from our closest hominin cousins.

In a study published Monday in the Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, an international team of researchers scrutinized a version of a gene, ubiquitous in humans today, that is not present in Neanderthals or Denisovans — the hominins that lived alongside our ancestors.

In a lab dish, the modern form of the gene in humans today made an enzyme less stable than the one found in hominin relatives. When researchers introduced that version into mice, they found that in females, it triggered a behavioral change — the mice were more adept at seeking water.

It's an intriguing clue — not an answer — to the question of how subtle changes to brain biochemistry may have meant the difference between hominins that went extinct and those that persisted and thrived.

In humans today, rare mutations to this gene, called ADSL, can cause brain dysfunction including symptoms similar to

SEE NEANDERTHAL ON A14



ALEX KENT/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

BY ERIN COX

Sharp knocks on the front door interrupted Firouzeh Firouzabadi's Saturday morning coffee. On the porch of her suburban Maryland home were two law enforcement agents and a very familiar pit bull mix named Duke.

"Can you take this dog?" Firouzabadi recalled one of the men saying. "I said, 'This is my son's dog. Where is he?' They wouldn't say."

At that moment, her adult son, Reza Zavvar, was handcuffed in the back of an SUV parked two

Destination unknown

Man who fled Iran 40 years ago may be deported to Romania or Australia, where he has no ties

Firouzeh Firouzabadi with a portrait of her son Reza Zavvar, who was arrested by ICE agents while walking his dog in suburban Maryland.

houses down in the Gaithersburg neighborhood where the Iranian-born family has lived since 2009 — apprehended, he later said, that late June day by at least five federal immigration agents in tactical gear who told Zavvar they had been waiting for him to take Duke out for his regular morning walk.

More than a month later, Zavvar, 52, remains in U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement custody, part of a surge of arrests of immigrants with standing court orders barring their

SEE ICE ON A20

Ordered to pay \$27,000 to a school her child never attended

Behind the polished images of the D.C. area's private institutions is a side not often seen: The lawsuits

BY BRITTANY SHAMMAS

The single mother stood alone before the judge, trying to convince him she shouldn't have to pay for an education her child never received.

Money was tight for Bianca Johnson, who was balancing a full-time job as an after-school care director with a full load of college classes in pursuit of a teaching career, and she had been counting on financial aid when she signed a contract to enroll her daughter at Sandy Spring Friends School. The private Quaker school, on a leafy campus in suburban Maryland, seemed like a perfect fit for her daughter, Teagan, a bubbly preschooler who was already starting to sound out words.

But when no aid became available by last August, Johnson reluctantly chose to keep her daughter in a YMCA program covered by a voucher. She was disappointed but thought the

SEE PRIVATE SCHOOL ON A8



ALLISON ROBERT/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Bianca Johnson and her daughter, Teagan, play in the living room of their home in Silver Spring.

Texas GOP seeks arrests

FLEEING DEMOCRATS REMAIN RESOLUTE

Special session grinds to halt without quorum

BY PATRICK MARLEY, YVONNE WINGETT SANCHEZ AND MOLLY HENNESSY-FISKE

CHICAGO — Texas Republicans on Monday sought to retaliate against Democrats who fled the state, voting to issue civil arrest warrants for dozens of lawmakers who left in an attempt to stymie a GOP effort to redraw the congressional map.

Democrats said they were undeterred by the move, and officials will have difficulty arresting them because most are in suburban Chicago and beyond the jurisdiction of Texas authorities. But the warrants demonstrate the seriousness of Republicans' desire to add congressional seats in what is quickly shaping up as a gerrymandering battle between red states and blue states. In response to Texas Republicans, Democratic governors in New York and California are preparing to try to reshape congressional boundaries in their favor.

"We are at war," New York Gov. Kathy Hochul (D) said Monday at a news conference with some of the Texas Democrats. "And that's why the gloves are off, and I say bring it on."

Addressing a partially empty

SEE TEXAS ON A4

FAQ: What may come next in the redistricting fight in the state. **A4**

Spending on AI is starting to rewire the U.S. economy

BY GERRIT DE VYNCK

SAN FRANCISCO — Big Tech's unprecedented spending spree on artificial intelligence is getting so big that it's starting to reshape the U.S. economy.

Google, Meta, Amazon and Microsoft recently reaffirmed that they are on track to spend more than \$350 billion this year building and equipping AI data centers — a massive influx of money that economists and analysts say could be a countervailing force to what appears to be a decelerating economy.

Revised job numbers released Friday by the Labor Department suggest the U.S. job market appears weaker than previously understood, with employers pulling back sharply on new hiring in May and June. At the same time, Big Tech's infusion of cash will go toward building and expanding data centers, which could create more infrastructure jobs as well as higher demand for computer chips, servers and other network equipment that power them. AI investments could grow the economy by as much as 0.7 percent in 2025, according to a calculation by Jens Nordvig, an economist and the founder of economic data platform Exante Data. That would represent half of the 1.4 percent

SEE AI ON A16

IN THE NEWS

Turmoil at BLS The statistical agency suggested to its staff that business would continue as usual in an email from its interim leader after the firing of its commissioner. **A6**
Md. mother reindicted Catherine Hoggie was again charged with murder in the 2014 disappearances of her two children. **B13**

THE NATION **Alexis Martin**, a prominent anti-sex-trafficking activist, was ordered released from prison. **A2**
Rep. Nancy Mace (R) announced her candidacy for governor of South Carolina. **A2**

THE WORLD **Afghans in Iran** are increasingly being forced back home, and many fear what lies ahead. **A11**
Residents are begging for Moscow's help as Russian-held Ukraine runs out of tap water. **A13**

THE ECONOMY **Tesla's board** awarded Elon Musk about \$30 billion worth of shares in an effort to retain him for years. **A15**

STYLE **Author Rax King** led a "dirtbag" tour of D.C.'s grittier side in honor of her new collection of essays, "Sloppy." **B1**

SPORTS **The Nationals'** interim skipper, Miguel Cairo, is managing this rebuild one step at a time. **B7**

THE REGION **President Donald Trump** suggested he might be ready to endorse Republican Winsome Earle-Sears for Virginia governor. **B13**

Paul G. Mahoney, a former law school dean, will serve as the University of Virginia's interim president. **B13**

OBITUARIES **Loni Anderson**, 79, was known for her role in "WKRP in Cincinnati" and marriage to Burt Reynolds. **B15**

BUSINESS NEWS.....A15
COMICS.....B4
OBITUARIES.....B15
OPINION PAGES.....A17
TELEVISION.....B6
WORLD NEWS.....A11

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54299

